

NASHVILLE BRIDE — Story Document / Paper Edit

Episode: "The Yes Dress" (Sarah & Garrison)

1. LOGLINE

A Nashville barista and single mom keeps postponing the wedding she and the man who became a father to her kids simply can't afford — until Dom and his three single coworkers surprise her with her dream gown, and in handing Sarah her forever, each of them edges closer to believing in their own.

2. STORY BREAKDOWN

A-STORY — Dom's gift (the spine).

Dom set out to remove the one thing standing between Sarah and her wedding: the dress. He hand-picks three gowns, previews them on a model so the team can strategize, then surprises Sarah with a VIP fitting that ends in a "yes dress" and a party. The engine of the episode is *anticipation* → *reveal* → *celebration*, and Dom's private stakes — a man who still believes in marriage after his own divorce — give the gift its weight.

B-STORY — The team's own hearts (personal investment).

All three women are single, pouring themselves into someone else's love story while quietly working on their own. Seeded at the rooftop in **Savannah's emotional story (2f)** and echoed in Danielle's self-love / "shadow work" journey, it pays off at the party: helping Sarah say yes makes each of them want — and believe they deserve — their own person. "We'll find our people one day."

C-STORY — Sarah & Garrison (the stakes).

They met at Sarah's brother's wedding, both in the wedding party. She's a single mom working a coffee counter; he's the steady guy who became a role model to her kids and writes her songs. They've set a date, changed it, and postponed it — financial stress, life stress — always putting the wedding last. The dress is the first domino. Take it down and "it's happening now."

3. CHARACTER ARCS (start → want → obstacle → end)

- **Dom** — *Start*: generous ringleader, all confidence and plan. *Wants*: to give Sarah a moment that proves marriage is still worth believing in. *Obstacle*: his own history — divorce, lean years, the thing he "had to give up" — makes this personal in a way he doesn't expect. *End*: undone by Sarah's tears, "balled like a baby," names the team his family.
- **Sarah (bride)** — *Start*: guarded, out of her element, "I don't know anything" about the day. *Wants*: to feel like a bride instead of a to-do list. *Obstacle*: a chaotic, money-tight life that's made the wedding feel impossible. *End*: "I feel like a wife." Glowing, crying, sure — the dress is better than what she pictured as a little girl.
- **Garrison (partner)** — *Start*: offscreen, the quiet "why aren't you married yet?" question. *Wants*: to finally give Sarah the wedding she deserves. *Obstacle*: finances, timing, pride. *End (offscreen but felt)*: set up

to "ball his eyes out" at the aisle; Dom frames him as the good man who earned this.

- **Danielle** — *Start*: warm, detail-loving real-estate pro and dog mom (Grace & Frankie). *Wants*: genuine connection after a rough romantic history. *Obstacle*: old patterns she's actively unlearning ("shadow work," a marriage that was really a visa, a petty ex). *End*: "I'm proud of myself" — pours her light into Sarah, lands on gratitude.
- **Savannah** — *Start*: the newcomer (PA → Maryland → Nashville), bubbly, still finding her footing. *Wants*: belonging and her own love story. *Obstacle*: she's the most freshly single, still bruised. *End (B-story payoff)*: seeing Sarah and Garrison reframes what she's looking for — "someone that truly sees me in the little moments."
- **Muff** — *Start*: the skeptic-with-taste, "corset girly," here for work, guarding her excitement. *Wants*: to nail the dress details and not get swept up. *Obstacle*: she gets swept up anyway. *End*: "I'm digging Sarah for sure" — predicts the yes dress, melts at the reveal, "bridal superheroes."

4. ACT-BY-ACT BEAT SHEET

Footage refs use scene/sub-scene codes + timecodes. INT = confessional/interview callouts.

Side-talk policy (whole episode): keep side talk that builds the three recurring threads — **line dancing** (rooftop "I want to line dance" → the party lesson pays it off), **Nashville** (the city, Broadway, real estate/development, "everybody's moving here"), and **personal** (single-life/dating, the dogs, self-love — feeds the B-story). Trim generic filler.

COLD OPEN — (~1:30) *emotion only, NO dress*

Beat	Action	Footage ref	INT bites	Function
CO-1	Dom, quiet: "a lot of brides can't afford to get married... the dress is the first piece to the puzzle."	S1 01:01:10–01:01:20	—	State the why
CO-2	Intimate stakes: Garrison "writes songs for you?... for our kids." A couple who put the wedding last.	S4 01:59:38; couple ref S3	—	Plant the love + the cost
CO-3	Tease the emotion: Sarah's eyes welling, "I've been trying not to cry"; girls holding back tears; Dom watching, jaw tight. Cut away BEFORE the gown.	S4 02:03:47 / 02:05:29 (reaction only); INT S5	INT-Dom: "When Sarah started crying... it brought my whole vision together." 02:15:11	Gut-hook, protect the reveal
CO-4	Dom button: "This is bigger than the whole thing."	S5/INT 04:22:30	—	Promise of payoff

TITLES.

ACT 1 — PICKLEBALL INTRO / THE BRIEF — (~6:30)

Beat	Action	Footage ref	INT bites	Function
1-1	Fun cold-energy open: pickleball, easy banter.	S1 01:00:05–01:00:17	—	Establish the family, glam-fun tone
1-2	The brief: "our bride next week" — the beach wedding, Sarah, fiancé Garrison; Dom's already picked her dresses.	S1 01:00:17–01:00:31	—	Set the mission target
1-3	The plan: rooftop, a model, champagne, "look at some dresses."	S1 01:00:36–01:00:53	—	Set up Act 2 anticipation
1-4	Heart beat: Dom — "you guys are a blessing... something I've always wanted to do is give back... y'all are my best friends."	S1 01:01:02–01:01:22	INT-girl: "she seems really nice."	Warmth; plant the team bond
1-5	Plant B-story: the girls riff single-life/dating; all in the same boat.	S2 side-talk 01:04:39–01:05:06	INT-Savannah (seed): new to Nashville.	Plant "all of us single"
ACT-OUT	"Y'all sold?" "Sold." Off to the rooftop — "convince us."	S1 01:00:53–01:01:00	—	Hook: what did Dom pick?

ACT 2 — ROOFTOP AT THE VINYL LOUNGE / THE PREVIEW — (~8:00)

Rule for this act: each dress beat is *about the dress* — that's the meat. Lead into each with only a short beat of side talk (a line or two), then get to the gown. Bank the rest of the small talk for 2-7's dedicated side-talk beat. Order: Dom + Alex → champagne → Dress 1 → Dress 2 → Dress 3 → side talk → Savannah.

Beat	Action	Footage ref	INT bites	Function
2-1	Dom arrives, introduces the model Alex — "this is Alex... we got Sarah, she's our bride."	2/S2 01:09:30–01:09:53	—	Kick the preview off
2-2	Champagne — toast/sip, skyline, "let's do it." Brief and glam. Lands <i>right after</i> Alex.	2a/S2 01:09:53–01:11:03 (B-roll; grab a "cheers to Sarah" on relisten)	—	Glam reset, energy up
2-3	(<i>short side-talk lead-in</i>) → Dress 1 — the beach / room-to-dance dress. Live reactions: "love it," "so cool," "it popped out and floated, stayed on top." Beach/dance character: "ease on the beach," champagne color, pearl/light.	2b/S2 walk 01:11:03; reactions 01:14:05–01:16:16; beach/dance 01:17:39 + 01:24:45	—	First gown; establish the beach + dance brief
2-4	(<i>short lead-in</i>) → Dress 2 — "it's very graphic," the top/shape ("the shape is perfect"), ballroom-vs-beach, "it's a contender." Dom: "I wanted to give her options."	2c/S2 01:16:46–01:18:33	—	Options = stakes; build the choice
2-5	(<i>short lead-in</i>) → Dress 3 — corset, sleeves, waistline; "I love a corset"; scores 8 / 8.5 / "10 — I want it." Dom: "those baby tears the first time... you know she found her dress."	2d/S2 01:22:00–01:24:21; Dom philosophy 01:22:18	INT-Dom: the "yes" moment is what he lives for.	Strongest gown; pre-sell the reveal

Beat	Action	Footage ref	INT bites	Function
2-6	Side talk — Dom's pick (torn 1 vs 2, champagne for the beach, "strong variety") + the recurring threads: line dancing ("our night might end in line dancing"), Nashville (Broadway, the city), personal (all-single/dating, dogs, the "Dom's always late" gag 01:07:06).	2e/S2 01:24:45–01:25:33; pre-arrival 01:01:35–01:09:08	—	Strategy + texture
2-7	VALLEY — Savannah's emotional story (B-story plant). Fun drops out for a quiet, real beat.	2f/S2 ~01:36:00–01:38:16 (<i>confirm narrator</i> — see Notes)	INT-Savannah: why this work hits home.	Plant the payoff; peaks & valleys
ACT-OUT	"Thank you, Alex." Dom: now we actually meet her.	2/S2 01:25:55–01:26:14	—	Hook: who is Sarah, really?

ACT 3 — MEETING SARAH / THE STAKES — (~8:00)

Beat	Action	Footage ref	INT bites	Function
3-1	The girls (+ Dom) surprise Sarah & Garrison at home. "What are you all doing here?"	S3 01:38:16–01:40:04	—	Meet the couple
3-2	How they met — at her brother's wedding, both in the wedding party.	3a/S3 01:41:35–01:41:48	—	Love-story origin
3-3	The ask that becomes the stakes: "Do you have a date?" — set, changed, postponed.	3a/S3 01:46:41–01:47:07	—	The wound
3-4	Heart of the C-story: "Why postponed? Financial reasons... I want to feel like a bride and not stress about other things."	3a/S3 01:47:19–01:47:48	INT-Dom: how much this means to her.	The emotional core
3-5	Garrison the good man: writes her songs, role model to her kids. Sarah: "I picked a good one."	S3 01:47:48–01:48:02; song ref S4 01:59:38	—	Make the audience root
3-6	Dom turns stakes into motion: "We're going to find you a dress today... girls day."	S3 01:47:58–01:48:34	—	Launch the fitting
ACT-OUT	Coffee-shop nod, pile into the car.	S3 01:48:19–01:48:33	—	Hook: will she find THE dress?

ACT 4 — BLUEGRASS BRIDAL / THE YES DRESS — (~10:00) ★ EMOTIONAL PEAK (≈²/₃ in)

Beat	Action	Footage ref	INT bites	Function
4-1	The walk-up: VIP welcome, Grace & Frankie the "welcoming committee," Yousuf to dress her.	4a/S4 01:49:13–01:50:24	—	Glam reset, warmth
4-2	Dress 1 — beaded ballgown. Stunning but "not my dancing dress" (90%-party wedding).	4b/S4 01:53:21–01:55:25	INT-girl: first impressions of Sarah.	Establish her taste; raise the bar

Beat	Action	Footage ref	INT bites	Function
4-3	Banter valley while she changes (personal thread): bonding, "bridal superheroes," all single together.	4b side-talk 01:50:47– 01:53:20	—	Tie B-story to the room
4-4	Dress 2 — graphic neckline, she glows: "more of a glow in your face." A real contender.	4c/S4 01:57:48– 02:00:41	—	False peak — "she might cry twice"
4-5	Strategy beat: "we can always add sleeves"; "there's a wedding dress and a party dress." "Now it's happening."	4c side-talk 02:01:04– 02:02:13	INT: changing lives "one bride at a time."	Hold tension before the win
4-6	★ DRESS 3 — THE YES DRESS. Deep-V corset, lace sleeves to the knuckles, train. Tears. "I feel like a wife." Veil — chills. "Is this the yes dress?" "Yes."	4d/S4 02:02:40– 02:05:17; veil 02:06–02:10; button 02:04:56 / 02:10:40	—	THE PEAK
4-7	Garrison seed pays forward: "He's gonna ball his eyes out." Dom welling up.	4d/S4 02:05:48– 02:06:00	—	Forward-promise to the wedding
4-8	SARAH-PRIORITY INTERVIEWS (rawest emotion). Bride first, then team.	4e/S4 02:13:45– 02:15:48	INT-Sarah (PRIORITY — see pickup note); INT-Danielle: "holding back tears" 02:14:34; INT-Muff: corset/sleeves "amazing in photos" 02:14:04; INT-Dom: "she found her dream dress" 02:15:11 / 02:17:06	Land the feeling
ACT-OUT	"Is this the yes dress? Yes — we have to go celebrate!"	4/S4 02:10:40– 02:10:55	—	Hook: the party / why did Dom do all this?

ACT 5 — PARTY CELEBRATION / THE SPEECH — (~11:00)

Beat	Action	Footage ref	INT bites	Function
5-1	Arrival; couple out of their element. The girls greet Sarah FIRST — "my tribe, my people."	5a/S5 03:09:01– 03:09:27; INT-Dom 04:33:20– 04:34:03	—	Reunion warmth
5-2	Line dancing (FUN PEAK) — Justin Lee teaches; flailing in heels, "yeehaw," laughter.	5b/S5 03:49:14– 03:59:40	INT-Muff: "favorite part... I'm a pro now" 04:32:00; INT-Danielle: "pretended I knew what I was doing — which is life" 04:39:21	High-energy glam-fun

Beat	Action	Footage ref	INT bites	Function
5-3	Side-talk valley — the recurring threads land: personal (dogs, single-life/dating, Danielle's visa story), Nashville (Leiper's Fork / real estate / "everybody's moving here"), line dancing recap.	5c/S5 + party b-roll	—	Breath before the speech; texture
5-4	PARTY INTERVIEWS — B-STORY PAYOFF. The single women, lit by Sarah's love story, name what they want.	5d/S5 04:24:10–04:41:58	INT-Danielle: "so much bigger than marriage" 04:37:34; INT-Savannah/Danielle: "someone who sees me in the little moments" 04:41:16; INT-Muff: "digging Sarah for sure" 04:29:35	Pay off the planted hearts
5-5	THE SPEECH (LAST — the button). Dom's toast: pain-to-purpose; met Garrison at the cigar bar, Sarah the barista who knows his order, the truck-battery day → "tell me your story." "Why aren't y'all married?... it's been tough, financially." "This was real for me... I balled like a baby."	5e/S5 04:11:18–04:23:06 (core 04:19:27–04:22:32)	INT-Dom (closer): won't feel it "until I'm on my back porch looking at the stars" 04:35:53–04:37:06	Final button — meaning over fun
5-6	"These people are my family." Cheers to Sarah & Garrison, cheers to all of us.	5e/S5 04:13:36–04:14:07 / 04:23:06	—	Land the family theme
ACT-OUT / TAG	Soft tag: a single woman's quiet hope, then "that's a wrap." Forward to the wedding (June 5, 2027) and the next bride.	5/S5 04:23:06–04:23:12; bride-forward INT 04:40:30	—	Button: "this is only the beginning"

5. COLD OPEN (60–90s) — build from these lines (emotion only, no gown)

- Dom, low and sincere: *"There's a lot of brides out there that just can't afford to get married... the dress is the first piece to the puzzle."* (S1 01:01:10)
- Hard cut to intimacy + stakes — Garrison *"writes songs for you?"* / songs with the kids (S4 01:59:38). A couple who keep putting the wedding last.
- Escalate on reaction shots only: Sarah welling, *"I've been trying not to cry"* (S4 02:03:47); a teammate wiping her eyes; **Dom watching**. Keep the camera off the dress.
- Button on Dom ITW: *"When Sarah started crying... it kind of brought my whole vision together"* (02:15:11) → *"This is bigger than the whole thing."* (04:22:30)
- Smash to TITLES before any wide of the gown.

6. RUNTIME BUDGET (target ~45:00)

Segment	Runtime
Cold Open	1:30
Act 1 — Pickleball / The Brief	6:30
Act 2 — Rooftop Preview (+ Savannah plant)	8:00
Act 3 — Meeting Sarah / The Stakes	8:00
Act 4 — The Yes Dress (peak + Sarah interviews)	10:00
Act 5 — Party / The Speech	11:00
Total	45:00

Peak placement: the yes dress lands at ~24:00 — just past two-thirds toward the credits — with the party as the warm runway.

7. NOTES (pacing flags, order options, pickups, build-from lines)

Pacing / structure

- Peaks & valleys are built in: pickleball-fun → Dom's heart; rooftop-glam → Savannah's story; coffee-shop levity → the postponement confession; two dresses → the yes dress; line dancing → the speech. Keep beat 4-3's banter between the gowns so two tender beats don't sit back-to-back.
- **Protect the reveal.** Dress 3 appears on the model (Act 2) and on Sarah (Act 4). In Act 2, favor partial frames + the scoring banter over a clean full-length, or the Act-4 reveal deflates.

Order options

- Breakdown order (preview → meet Sarah) builds anticipation best — recommended. Alt: open Act 2 with a short meet-Sarah tease cross-cut into the rooftop if the rooftop plays "abstract."
- Savannah's story (2f) can float into Act 5's interview block if Act 2 runs long — but plant at least a line on the rooftop.

Missing / recommended pickups

- **Champagne toast is B-roll.** No clean "cheers to Sarah" line was captured. Relisten 01:09:53–01:11:03; if one exists, it's the button on the champagne beat.
- **PRIORITY: Sarah's solo confessional.** The rules want the bride's interview rawest, right after the reveal (4e), but the transcript has only in-scene reactions. Grab a bride ITW: how the dress compared to her childhood picture, what not stressing about the wedding means, what Garrison will feel at the aisle.
- **Garrison reaction pickup.** He's pure setup and never seen reacting — a short ITW or aisle-day tag closes his arc.
- **Speaker-ID verification.** ASR blurs Danielle / Savannah / Muff. Confirm who delivers the home-care/"deathbed" reflection (~01:36–01:38), the self-love lines (~02:22), and the visa-marriage backstory (~03:48 / 04:03). Breakdown assigns 2f to Savannah; the transcript's richest single-woman material may be Danielle's — assign the B-story to whoever is on screen and keep it consistent. (See companion [Nashville_Bride_SpeakerID_Worksheet](#).)

Lines to build cold opens / act-outs from

- Cold open: *"The dress is the first piece to the puzzle." / "This is bigger than the whole thing."*
- Act 1 out: *"Y'all sold?" "Sold."*
- Act 2 out (theme): *"You see those baby tears for the first time — you know she found her dress."*
- Act 3 out: *"Get your bags packed — you're coming with us. Girls day."*
- Act 4 out: *"Is this the yes dress?" "Yes."*
- Act 5 / series-forward: *"This is only the beginning." / "Bridal chose me."*